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Fractional handpiece system

Abstract

An assembly with a handpiece assembly configured to receive electromagnetic energy and fluid, and to selectively deliver the electromagnetic energy and/or the fluid to a target surface. The handpiece assembly includes a handpiece housing and a plurality of fluid lines extending through the handpiece housing. The plurality of fluid lines can transfer fluid from a proximal end of the handpiece assembly to a distal end of the handpiece assembly. A spray mixer can be positioned at the distal end that is coupled to fluid lines of the plurality of fluid lines. An air input port can be positioned at the proximal end that is configured to be coupled to an auxiliary air hose, and an air delivery channel can be coupled to the air input port, and can supply air to a tip of an exchangeable applicator that can be coupled to the distal end of the handpiece housing.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This patent application claims the benefit of and is a continuation of co-pending U.S. Publication Ser. No. 16/113,803, filed on Aug. 27, 2018, which claims the benefit of priority to U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 62/550,509, filed on Aug. 25, 2017, which are incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) A conventional medical handpiece typically includes a waveguide (e.g., a fiber optic or trunk fiber) coupled to a laser housing or module that provides electromagnetic (e.g., laser) energy that can be directed to a target surface such as bone, skin, dental tissue, or other biological surface. Some medical procedures utilize water spray, mist or vapor and/or air or other inert gas in combination with a laser pulse to enhance treatment efficacy. Some medical procedures benefit from (or require) disposable applicator tips that can be used in close proximity to, or in contact with, the patient's tissue during treatment, and disposed of after use. The ergonomic packaging of supply lines and delivery nozzles for air and water within a handpiece that maintains an ability to enable swift and user-friendly exchange of disposable applicator tips remains a challenge from a design, manufacturing, and cost perspective.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(2) Some embodiments include an assembly comprising a handpiece assembly configured to receive and electromagnetic energy and at least one fluid, and to selectively deliver at least one of the electromagnetic energy and the at least one fluid to a target surface. In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly comprises a handpiece housing and a plurality of fluid lines extending through the handpiece housing. In some embodiments, the plurality of fluid lines can transfer at least one fluid from a proximal end of the handpiece assembly to a distal end of the handpiece assembly. Some embodiments include a spray mixer positioned at the distal end that is coupled to fluid lines of the plurality of fluid lines. Some further embodiments include an air input port positioned at the proximal end that is configured to be coupled to an auxiliary air hose. Some embodiments include an air delivery channel coupled to the air input port and that can supply air to a tip of an exchangeable applicator configured to be coupled to the distal end of the handpiece housing.

(3) In some embodiments, the assembly further comprises a disposable applicator comprising at least one structure configured and arranged to weaken or have reduced mechanical strength or integrity of at least one coupler or clip extending from a main body of the disposable applicator. The at least one coupler or clip is configured and arranged to at least partially secure the disposable tip to the distal end of the handpiece assembly.

(4) In some embodiments, the at least one structure comprises a notch. In some embodiments, the notch is positioned at an edge of the main body and extends at least partially into the at least one coupler or clip, where the at least one coupler or clip is configured by the notch to break from the main body when a user removes the disposable applicator from the handpiece assembly.

(5) Some embodiments include a system comprising a laser delivery system configured to deliver electromagnetic energy via a fiber optic cable. Some embodiments include a handpiece assembly

configured to be coupled to the fiber optic cable to receive the electromagnetic energy. In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly is configured to receive at least one fluid and to selectively deliver at least one of the electromagnetic energy and the at least one fluid to a target surface. In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly comprises a spray mixer positioned at a distal end of the handpiece assembly, and coupled to fluid lines of the plurality of fluid lines.

(6) Some embodiments include an air input port positioned at a proximal end of the handpiece assembly, and configured to be coupled to an auxiliary air hose. Some further embodiments include an air delivery channel coupled to the air input port and configured to supply air to the target surface via an exchangeable coupled disposable applicator.

(7) Some embodiments of the invention include a GUI display communicatively linked to or included in the laser delivery system. The GUI display is configured to display at least one operating status or selectable parameter of the handpiece assembly.

(8) Some embodiments include a processor and a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium in data communication with the processor. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium includes a process executable by the processor that enables a user to interact with the GUI to select or change one or more one or more settings or parameters and/or monitor one or more functions of the handpiece assembly.

(9) In some embodiments, one or more one or more settings or parameters of the handpiece assembly include at least one of a laser power, and a laser pulse width. In some embodiments, the one or more one or more settings or parameters of the handpiece assembly comprises at least one selectable favorite selected from a GUI comprising a favorites selection window or icon. In some further embodiments, the one or more one or more settings or parameters of the handpiece assembly comprises at least one selectable category selected from a GUI comprising a category selection window.

(10) In some embodiments, the GUI comprises a spray parameter display configured for displaying and/or controlling spray parameters of the handpiece assembly. In some embodiments, the GUI includes a power meter with selectable power level, and/or a laser mode display and/or selector, and/or a selectable slider configured for modifying and/or setting at least one parameter of a procedure, and/or a pulse display with selectable pulse icon.

(11) In some embodiments of the invention, the GUI includes an air delivery display with air setting and/or air mode. In some further embodiments, the GUI includes a water delivery display with water setting, and water mode icon. In some embodiments, the GUI includes an auxiliary icon configured for selecting or indicating auxiliary components and/or sources providing air and/or water. In some other embodiments, the GUI includes a handpiece exchange icon and/or tip exchange icon configurable to install and/or swap a handpiece and/or tip of the handpiece assembly.

(12) In some embodiments of the invention, the disposable applicator comprises at least one structure configured and arranged to weaken or reduce the mechanical strength or integrity of at least one coupler or clip extending from a main body of the disposable applicator. The at least one coupler or clip is configured and arranged to at least partially secure the disposable tip to the distal end of the handpiece assembly. In some embodiments of the system, the at least one structure comprises a notch.

(13) In some embodiments of the system, the notch is positioned at an edge of the main body of the disposable applicator, and extends at least partially into the at least one coupler or clip, where the at least one coupler or clip is configured by the notch to break from the main body when a user removes the disposable applicator from the handpiece assembly.

(14) In some embodiments, the spray mixer is positioned in a lower housing extension that curves inward so that an output of the spray mixer is guided towards an axial center of the handpiece assembly. In some embodiments, the disposable applicator comprises a valve configured to couple

to a connector at the distal end of the handpiece assembly. In some embodiments, the valve comprises a duckbill valve.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 illustrates a perspective view of a handpiece assembly in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (2) FIG. 2 illustrates an assembly view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (3) FIG. 3 illustrates an exploded assembly view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (4) FIG. 4 illustrates a cross-sectional view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (5) FIG. 5A illustrates a cross-sectional view of the distal end of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (6) FIG. 5B illustrates an assembly view of the distal end of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates a front view of the distal applicator tip positioned on the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates a partial top view of the distal applicator tip positioned on the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (9) FIG. 7A illustrates an assembly view of a disposable applicator tip in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (10) FIG. 7B illustrates a front view of the disposable applicator tip of FIG. 7A in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (11) FIG. 7C illustrates a cross-section view through “A” of the disposable applicator tip of FIG. 7B in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (12) FIG. 7D illustrates a cross-section view through “E” of the disposable applicator tip of FIG. 7B in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (13) FIG. 7E illustrates a close-up view of the notch shown in FIG. 7D in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (14) FIG. 8 illustrates a top view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (15) FIG. 9 illustrates a bottom view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (16) FIG. 10 illustrates a front distal end view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (17) FIG. 11 illustrates a rear proximal end view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (18) FIG. 12 illustrates a left-side view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (19) FIG. 13 illustrates a right-side view of the handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (20) FIGS. 14A-14B show example dental laser stations in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.
- (21) FIG. 14C illustrates a handpiece assembly with a coupled fiber optic cable in accordance some embodiments of the invention.
- (22) FIG. 14D illustrates a handpiece assembly with a fiber optic cable and coupled air supply tube

in accordance some embodiments of the invention.

(23) FIG. 14E illustrates the handpiece assembly in operation in contact mode in accordance some embodiments of the invention.

(24) FIG. 14F illustrates a beam and spray of the handpiece assembly in accordance some embodiments of the invention.

(25) FIG. 15 illustrates a computer system useful for controlling, monitoring, and/or networking to a dental laser station controlling a handpiece assembly of FIG. 1 in accordance with some embodiments of the invention in accordance some embodiments of the invention.

(26) FIGS. 16-17, and 17A illustrate example GUI displays configured for showing operational and control parameters of the handpiece assembly.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(27) Before any embodiments of the invention are explained in detail, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited in its application to the details of construction and the arrangement of components set forth in the following description or illustrated in the following drawings. The invention is capable of other embodiments and of being practiced or of being carried out in various ways. Also, it is to be understood that the phraseology and terminology used herein is for the purpose of description and should not be regarded as limiting. The use of “including,”

“comprising,” or “having” and variations thereof herein is meant to encompass the items listed thereafter and equivalents thereof as well as additional items. Unless specified or limited otherwise, the terms “mounted,” “connected,” “supported,” and “coupled” and variations thereof are used broadly and encompass both direct and indirect mountings, connections, supports, and couplings. Further, “connected” and “coupled” are not restricted to physical or mechanical connections or couplings.

(28) The following discussion is presented to enable a person skilled in the art to make and use embodiments of the invention. Various modifications to the illustrated embodiments will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the generic principles herein can be applied to other embodiments and applications without departing from embodiments of the invention. Thus, embodiments of the invention are not intended to be limited to embodiments shown, but are to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and features disclosed herein. The following detailed description is to be read with reference to the figures, in which like elements in different figures have like reference numerals. The figures, which are not necessarily to scale, depict selected embodiments and are not intended to limit the scope of embodiments of the invention. Skilled artisans will recognize the examples provided herein have many useful alternatives that fall within the scope of embodiments of the invention.

(29) The various embodiments of the invention described herein include devices, apparatus, systems and methods to enable the use and control and/or monitoring of complex dental laser procedures. Further, some embodiments of the invention can include control systems, displays, and associated user interfaces that can be used to control some aspect of a dental laser system, and/or communicate some function or operational characteristic of the tool to the user. For example, some embodiments can include control systems, displays, and user interfaces that can be used to perform procedures related to dental restoration and oral disease prevention. More specifically, some embodiments of the invention described herein include devices, apparatus, systems and methods to enable a user to operate and/or monitor the functional aspects of dental laser systems using interfaces that can be customized for a specific dental procedure and/or for any specific dental specialty including, but not limited to general dentistry, oral and maxillofacial dentistry, orthodontic dentistry, endodontic dentistry, pediatric dentistry, cosmetic dentistry, and so on.

(30) Some embodiments include a handpiece configured to operate with one or more specific lasers. Further, some embodiments include water atomization technologies that can be used during laser use. Some embodiments include a handpiece configured to function with a specific tissue laser and water atomization technologies to ablate skin and/or reshape soft tissue with minimal

trauma and maximum efficacy. For example, in some embodiments, the handpiece can function to provide skin resurfacing, and scar revision including acne scarring, and treatment of wrinkles. In reference to FIG. 1, showing a perspective view of a handpiece assembly **10**, some embodiments include a handpiece assembly **10** that includes a longitudinal housing **12** formed from the coupling of a left-side shell **15a** to a right-side shell **15b** extending from a distal end **11a** to a proximal end **11b**. In some embodiments, the housing **12** can comprise a generally cylindrical first body portion **13a** extending from the proximal end **11b** to a transition body region **13b** that begins about half-way along the longitudinal length of the housing **12**, and extends towards second body portion **13c** extending to the distal end **11a**.

(31) In some other embodiments, the longitudinal housing **12** can be assembled using more than two halves (e.g., where the left-side shell **15a** and right-side shell **15b** represent two halves in the non-limiting embodiment, but could be shaped to comprise two portions capable of coupling to one or more additional portions to form the housing **12**). In some embodiments, the shells **15a**, **15b** and/or any additional or other portions forming the housing **12** can be permanently coupled. In some other embodiments, the shells **15a**, **15b** and/or any additional or other portions forming the housing **12** can be reversibly coupled.

(32) In some embodiments, the housing **12** can include various extensions and/or compartments configured to house one or more accessories and/or various inputs and/or outputs (e.g., such as inputs and outputs for air and fluid and/or mixtures thereof). For example, some embodiments include an upper housing extension **16** comprising a left-side **16a** and right-side **16b** extending from the first body portion **13a** of the housing **12** adjacent the proximal end **11b**. Some further embodiments include a lower housing extension **18** comprising a left-side **18a** and right-side **18b** extending in an opposite direction to the upper housing extension from the second body portion **13c** of the distal end **11a**. In some other embodiments of the invention, the handpiece assembly **10** includes a housing extension **67** comprising a left-side **67a** and right-side **67b** extending in an opposite direction to the lower housing extension **18** and generally positioned on the opposite side of the second body portion **13c** adjacent the distal end **11a**. In some embodiments, any one or more of the extensions **16**, **18**, **67** can be coupled to the housing **12**. In other embodiments, any of the extensions **16**, **18**, **67** can be integral to the housing **12**.

(33) In some embodiments of the invention, the upper housing extension **16** can include a conventional linkage or coupling that can enable the reversible coupling of a fluid input. For example, in some embodiments, the upper housing extension **16** can include a luer lock coupling **50** that can enable the coupling of the handpiece assembly to an auxiliary air input. In some embodiments, the luer lock coupling **50** can extend from the upper housing extension **16** towards the proximal end **11b** and generally axially aligned with longitudinal length of the housing **12**. In some embodiments, the proximal end **11b** of the first body portion **13a** of the housing **12** can include a plug **45** coupled to the proximal end **11b** adjacent an exhaust **40**.

(34) Some embodiments include an air coupler housing **121** extending from the distal end **11a** and coupled to the housing extension **67**. In some embodiments, the air coupler housing **121** can enable coupling of air or other gas to the handpiece assembly **10** by an air delivery line (not shown) for providing a supply of on-demand air. In some further embodiments, the air coupler housing **121** can be couple to, or integrated with, a disposable applicator (see below in related to FIGS. 7A-7E).

(35) Some embodiments of the invention include a protective lens cap **90** positioned coupled to and extending from the distal end **11a**. In some embodiments of the invention, the protective lens cap **90** can be coupled to the housing **12** during periods of storage and non-use, and can be removed prior to use and/or when installing an applicator tip. In reference to FIG. 2, illustrating an assembly view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention, the handpiece assembly **10** can include an applicator **125**. In some embodiments, the cap **90** and applicator **125** are interchangeable or swappable components of the handpiece assembly **10**. In other words, in some embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** can comprise the cap **90**, and in

other embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** can comprise the applicator **125**. As shown in FIG. **2**, in some embodiments, the distal end **11a** of the housing **12** can include an optical housing **20** (showing the distal end). In some embodiments, the cap **90** and/or the applicator **125** can couple to the optical housing **20**. In some further embodiments, the housing assembly **10** can include other peripheral attachments, accessories, covers, and stands or supports as needed and/or selected by a user.

(36) The optical housing **20** and other related components and structure of the handpiece assembly **10** can be seen in further detail in FIG. **3**, showing an exploded assembly view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. **1**. In some embodiments of the invention, the optical housing **20** can house and support various optical components and support elements that can facilitate unobstructed and controlled delivery of laser energy through the housing **12** and out of the applicator **125**. For example, in some embodiments, from the proximal end **11a** towards the distal end **11b**, the optical housing **20** can support and/or house an inner housing **115** coupled into the optical housing **20**, an optical grating **110**. Further, a spacer **105** can be positioned between the optical grating **110** and lens **100**, and a nut **95** can secure the grating **110**, spacer **105**, and lens **100** to the distal end of the optical housing **20**. Moving from the distal end of the optical housing **20** towards the proximal end **11b** of the handpiece assembly **10**, in some embodiments, the optical housing **20** can couple to a longitudinal extension **25**. In some embodiments, the longitudinal extension **25** can extend towards the proximal end **11b** of the handpiece assembly **10**, and can be coupled with the cylinder **30** at one end, and plug **45** can be coupled with the opposite cylinder end **35**. In some embodiments of the invention, the proximal end of the cylinder adjacent the end **35** can include a spring **37** seated over a ball **34** positioned in ball seat **33**. In some embodiments, various washers, seals, or other coupling elements or containment rings can be used to secure and/or seal one or more of the aforementioned components of the assembly **10**. For example, some embodiments include O-ring **22** and/or O-ring **42** as shown.

(37) In some embodiments of the invention, the handpiece assembly **10** can be coupled to an applicator that is disposable, and structured to be used with the handpiece assembly **10** once. For example, FIG. **7A** illustrates an assembly view of a disposable applicator **225** in accordance with some embodiments of the invention, and FIG. **7B** illustrates a front view of the disposable applicator **225** of FIG. **7A** in accordance with some embodiments of the invention. In some embodiments, the applicator **225** can include a tip **227** extending from the tip body **226**. In some embodiments, the tip **227** can include a tip end surface **227a** that can be coupled to a patient's tissue, and applicator aperture **228** that can enable passage of laser energy, water, air (or other fluid), or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, during a treatment, laser radiation can pass through the optical housing and out of the aperture **228** with or without air or other fluid delivery from the delivery channel **230**. Further, in some embodiments, either or both of the tubing **75**, **77** can deliver fluid spray or mist and/or fluid to a region close to a target surface (e.g., such as bone, skin, dental tissue, or other biological surface) proximate the applicator **225**.

(38) In some embodiments, an air coupler housing **221** can extend from mating coupler **220** of the applicator body **226**. In some embodiments, the air coupler housing **221** and applicator body **226** can be integral and structured to couple with the housing extension **67** and second body portion **13c** of the handpiece assembly **10**. In reference to FIG. **7C**, illustrating a cross-section view through "A" of the disposable applicator tip of FIG. **7B**, in some embodiments, the air coupler housing **221** can include the delivery channel **230** extending through at least a partial length of the air coupler housing **221** and coupled with tip channel **232**, enabling fluid (e.g., such as air) to flow to the aperture **228**. In some embodiments, to facilitate coupling of the connector **65** at the distal end **11a** of the handpiece assembly **10** to the delivery channel **230** of the applicator body **226**, the applicator body **226** can include a valve **250** (e.g., such as a duckbill valve) coupled to a seal **255**. Thus, in some embodiments, when the disposable applicator **225** is coupled to the handpiece assembly **10**, the connector can reversibly slide into the seal and couple to the valve **250**. Further, as shown in

FIGS. 7A and 7C, in some embodiments, the disposable applicator **225** can include a lens or window **245**. In some embodiments, the window **245** can enable laser energy to travel out of the applicator body **226** and through the aperture **228** while maintaining a seal from the tip channel **232** and aperture **228**.

(39) In some embodiments, the applicator body **226** can be structured so that removal of the applicator from the handpiece assembly **10** causes at least a portion of the applicator break-away, rendering the applicator non-functional. FIG. 7D illustrates a cross-section view through “E” of the disposable applicator tip of FIG. 7B in accordance with some embodiments of the invention. In some embodiments, the applicator body **226** can include at least one applicator clip **222** that can couple to the mating form **140** of the handpiece assembly **10** with clip stop **142** being positioned at least partially through the clip **222** to secure the disposable applicator **225** to the second body portion **13c**. As shown in FIG. 7D, and in close-up view of FIG. 7E, some embodiments include a notch **260** positioned at the edge **226a** where the clip **222** extends away from the applicator body **226** and tip **227**, and extending at least partially into the clip **222**. In some embodiments, when the disposable applicator **225** is removed from the second body portion **13c** of the handpiece assembly **10**, the notch **260** can facilitate energy transfer through the clip **222** at the edge **226a** so that the portion of the clip **222** extending away from the notch **260** breaks-away from the applicator body **226**. In some embodiments, this serves to ensure or encourage the disposable applicator **226** is not reused with the handpiece assembly **10** because the disposable applicator **226** cannot be secured to the second body portion **13c** of the handpiece assembly **10**.

(40) In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 3 can include more or less O-rings, washers, seals, or other coupling elements or containment rings that can be used to secure and/or seal one or more of the aforementioned components of the assembly **10** without significantly changing or altering the operation and functional characteristics of the assembly **10**. Various views of the handpiece assembly **10** are shown in further detail in FIGS. 8-13. For example, FIG. 8 illustrates a top view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 1, and FIG. 9 illustrates a bottom view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 1 in accordance some embodiments of the invention. Further, FIG. 10 illustrates a front distal end view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 1, and FIG. 11 illustrates a rear proximal end view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 1 in accordance with some embodiments of the invention. Further, FIG. 12 illustrates a left-side view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 1, and FIG. 13 illustrates a right-side view of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. 1 in accordance with some embodiments of the invention.

(41) In some embodiments of the invention, the handpiece assembly **10** can be used to perform one or more medical, surgical, dental, or other health-related procedures using water spray, mist or vapor and/or air or other inert gas. In some embodiments, the water spray, mist or vapor and/or air or other inert gas can be used in combination with one or more laser pulses during the treatment. In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** can include one or more supply lines and/or one or more delivery nozzles for air and/or water. In reference to exploded assembly view of FIG. 3, and FIG. 4 illustrating a cross-sectional view of the handpiece assembly **10**, in some embodiments, the assembly **10** can include spray tubing **75** and/or water tubing **77**. In some embodiments, the tubing **75**, **77** can extend at least a partial length of the housing **12** extending from the proximal end **11b** to the distal end **11a**. In some embodiments, either or both tubes **75**, **77** can couple into a spray mixer **84** with the tubes **75**, **77** supported in a holder **80** and an O-ring **82** coupling the spray mixer **84** with the holder **80** positioned in the lower housing extension **18**. Further, in some embodiments, the spray mixer **84** can be positioned at the distal end **11a** on the side of the handpiece assembly **10** opposite or generally opposite the connector **65** and tubes **60**, **70** for delivery of air or other fluid. In some embodiments, the air or other fluid delivery through one or more of the tubes **60**, **70** can provide cooling and/or a positive pressure environment at a target or treatment site or area, and further, can remove debris from the area being lasered. Further, as shown in FIG. 4, in some embodiments, either or both tubes **75**, **77** can extend through and be supported by at least a portion

of the lower housing extension **18**. In some embodiments, the spray mixer **84** can deliver air and water or other fluid. In some embodiments, the spray mixer **84** can deliver air and water or other fluid across a beam of electromagnetic energy emitted from the distal end **11a** of the handpiece assembly **10**. For example, in some embodiments, the lower housing extension **18** can curve inward so that the holder **80** positions the tubes **75, 77** pointing inward towards an axial center of the handpiece assembly. The effect of this can be seen in FIG. **14F**.

(42) In some embodiments, the assembly **10** can include tubing **60** and/or tubing **70**. In some embodiments, the tubing **60, 70** can extend at least a partial length of the housing **12** extending from the proximal end **11b** to the distal end **11a**. In some embodiments, either or both tubing **60, 70** can couple into a connector **65** at the distal end **11a** on one side of the handpiece assembly **10**, and the connector **55** at the proximal end **11b** of the handpiece assembly **10**. Further, in some embodiments, the connector **55** can couple to the luer lock coupling **55**. As shown in FIG. **4**, in some embodiments, either or both tubes **60, 70** can extend through and be supported by at least a portion of the housing extension **67**.

(43) As described earlier, some embodiments the handpiece assembly **10** can include an applicator **125**. In some embodiments, the applicator **125** can be used in close proximity to or in contact with a target tissue in preparation for and during treatment. In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** can utilize one or more structural features to facilitate ergonomic packaging of supply lines and delivery nozzles for air and water and operation with a disposable applicator **125**. In some embodiments, the applicator **125** is interchangeable. In some other embodiments, the applicator **125** can be disposable. In some embodiments, the applicator **125** can couple to the optical housing **20**. In some embodiments of the invention, the optical housing **20** can facilitate delivery of laser energy through the housing **12** and out of the tip **125**.

(44) FIG. **5A** illustrates a cross-sectional view of the distal end **11a** of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. **1** in accordance with some embodiments of the invention, and FIG. **5B** illustrates an assembly view of the distal end **11b** of the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. **1** in accordance with some embodiments of the invention. Further, FIG. **6** illustrates a front view of the distal applicator **125** positioned on the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. **1** in accordance with some embodiments of the invention, and FIG. **7** illustrates a partial top view of the distal applicator **125** positioned on the handpiece assembly **10** of FIG. **1** in accordance with some embodiments of the invention. In some embodiments, a mating coupler **120** positioned on the applicator body **126** can couple with an air coupler housing **121**. In some embodiments, the air coupler housing **121** and applicator body **126** can be integral (and thus is not an integral portion of the second body portion **13c**). In some embodiments, the air coupler housing **121** can include a delivery channel **130** extending through at least a partial length of the air coupler housing **121** and coupled with a coupler orifice **131**. In some embodiments, the housing **121** can couple to the mating coupler **120** of the applicator **125**, and can further couple to the second body portion **13c** of the housing **12**, and further to the housing extension **67**.

(45) In some embodiments, the air coupler housing **121** and applicator body **126** can be integral (and thus is not an integral portion of the second body portion **13c**). In some embodiments, the mating coupler **120** and air coupler housing **121** are integral, and the applicator **125** including the mating coupler **120** and air coupler housing **121** can couple to the second body portion **13c** of the housing **12**. As illustrated in FIGS. **5A** and **5B**, in some embodiments, the air coupler housing **121** can couple to air delivery connector **123**, and at least one applicator clip **122** can couple to a mating form **140** with clip stop **142** being positioned at least partially through the clip **122** to secure the applicator **125** to the second body portion **13c** of the housing. In some embodiments, the clip-stop **142** can be positioned and structured to be reversibly engaged with the applicator clip **122** to enable the applicator **125** to be attached and removed and replaced with another applicator **125**. In some embodiments, any air or other cooling fluid source coupled to the auxiliary air input (luer lock coupling **50**) can flow through tubing **60, 70**, through the air deliver connector **123** to the delivery

channel **130**, and into the coupled tip channel **132** of the applicator **125** via coupler orifice **131**.

(46) In some embodiments of the invention, the handpiece assembly **10** can be used as a treatment device in contact mode (e.g., a portion of the handpiece assembly **10** can contact a portion of a patient during treatment). In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** can include or couple to a disposable applicator **125** (attached to the distal end **11a** of handpiece assembly **10**) that is applied directly to the skin when the laser is fired. As shown in FIGS. **2-3**, and **5A-5B**, in some embodiments, the applicator **125** can include a tip **127** extending from the applicator body **126**. In some embodiments, the tip **127** can include a tip end surface **127a** that can be coupled to a patient's tissue, and applicator aperture **128** that can enable passage of laser energy, water, air (or other fluid), or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, during a treatment, laser radiation can pass through the optical housing and out of the aperture **128** with or without air or other fluid delivery from the delivery channel **130**. Further, in some embodiments, either or both of the tubing **75**, **77** can delivery fluid spray or mist and/or fluid to a region close to a target surface proximate the applicator **125**.

(47) In some embodiments, the dental laser can include a variety of different lasers, laser diodes, or other sources of light. In some embodiments of the invention, the handpiece can be utilized with a laser generating multiple microbeams in a single line per laser pulse. In some embodiments of the invention, the dental laser can include one or more erbium, chromium, yttrium, scandium, gallium garnet lasers (Er, Cr:YSGG). In some other embodiments, the laser sources of embodiments of the handpiece described herein can include an erbium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (Er:YAG) solid state laser; a chromium, thulium, erbium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (CTE:YAG) solid state laser; an erbium, yttrium orthoaluminate (Er:YALO3) solid state laser; a holmium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (Ho:YAG) solid state laser; a quadrupled neodymium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (quadrupled Nd:YAG) solid state laser; an excimer laser; or a carbon dioxide (CO.sub.2) laser.

(48) Some embodiments can use a combination of at least two laser wavelengths that can, in some embodiments, be implemented with a variety of different laser modules. In some embodiments, the use of two lasers outputting radiation at two different wavelengths can be used to achieve a synergistic effect. For example, in some embodiments, the radiation of a first wavelength is used to generate pressure waves within a fluid inside the root canal, and the pressure waves increase efficacy of a thermal disinfection that results from the application of radiation of a second wavelength. Thus, the radiation of the first wavelength prepares the area for the disinfection that occurs through using the radiation of the second wavelength.

(49) In some embodiments, the electromagnetic energy source can be an erbium, chromium, yttrium, scandium, gallium garnet (Er, Cr:YSGG) solid state laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength in a range of 2.70 to 2.80 microns. According to other embodiments of the invention, the electromagnetic energy source may be an erbium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (Er:YAG) solid state laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength of 2.94 microns; chromium, thulium, erbium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (CTE:YAG) solid state laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength of 2.69 microns; erbium, yttrium orthoaluminate (Er:YALO.sub.3) solid state laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength in a range of 2.71 to 2.86 microns; holmium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (Ho:YAG) solid state laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength of 2.10 microns; quadrupled neodymium, yttrium, aluminum garnet (quadrupled Nd:YAG) solid state laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength of 266 nanometers; argon fluoride (ArF) excimer laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength of 193 nanometers; xenon chloride (XeCl) excimer laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength of 308 nanometers; krypton fluoride (KrF) excimer laser, which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength of 248 nanometers; and carbon dioxide (CO.sub.2), which generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength in a range of 9 to 10.6 microns. In some embodiments, the electromagnetic energy can be generated using at least one laser diode. In some

embodiments, the laser that includes a laser diode that generates electromagnetic energy having a wavelength that ranges from about 405 nm to about 1320 nm.

(50) In some embodiments of the invention, the total laser power output of the handpiece can be up to about 9 Watts at about 15 Hz. In some embodiments of the invention, the total energy per pulse can be set between 10 mJ and 600 mJ. In some embodiments of the invention, the energy per spot from the handpiece can be 10 mJ to 60 mJ. In some embodiments, the spot diameter can be between 200 μ m and 600 μ m. In some embodiments, the energy per spot can be 10 J/cm.² to 200 J/cm.². In some embodiments, the depth of one hole can be up to 1 mm. In some embodiments, the surface coverage can be 5% to 50%. In addition, the range of power in another embodiment can now go to 16 watts at 15 hz, 1,000 mJ, and energy per spot up to 100 mJ.

(51) Some non-limiting embodiments of the invention can include the handpiece assembly **10** being a handpiece **205** of the dental laser station **200** shown in FIG. **14A**. In other embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** can be a handpiece **255** of the dental laser station **250** shown in FIG. **14B**. In some embodiments of the invention, the handpiece assembly **10** can form part of a dental laser system that includes a display. In some embodiments, the display can comprise a touchscreen display configured to enable a user to interact with a graphical user interface (hereafter “GUI”). In some embodiments, user interactions with the GUI can include using single, multiple, or repeated physical contact with the display to initiate one or more functions of the dental laser system and a coupled handpiece. For example, in some embodiments, the display can include a GUI comprising one or more displayed menus that can be navigated by user to control or monitor one or more functions of the handpiece assembly **10**. For example, some non-limiting embodiments include of dental laser station **200** includes display **201** including a GUI **203**, and another non-limiting example embodiments includes dental laser station **250** with display **251** including a GUI **253**.

(52) As described earlier, some embodiments the handpiece assembly **10** can include an applicator **125**, **225**. In some embodiments, the applicator **125**, **225** can be used in close proximity to, or in contact with, a target tissue in preparation for and during treatment. Further, in some embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** can utilize one or more structural features to facilitate ergonomic packaging of supply lines and delivery nozzles for air and water and operation with a disposable applicator **125**, **225**, thus ensuring the operator can maneuver the handpiece assembly **10** on or over a treatment area of a patient without the risk of unintentional dragging or snagging of supply lines and delivery nozzles.

(53) In some embodiments, the handpiece assembly **10** (e.g., such as handpiece **205** and/or handpiece **255**) can be configured to receive laser energy by coupling to a fiber optic cable that can be coupled to a source of electromagnetic energy. For example, FIG. **14C** illustrates a handpiece assembly with a fiber optic cable **160** in accordance some embodiments of the invention. Further, in some embodiments of the invention, the upper housing extension **16** can enable reversible coupling of a fluid input, where the upper housing extension **16** can include a luer lock coupling **50** that can enable the coupling of the handpiece assembly **10** to an auxiliary air input tube **155**. In some embodiments, the auxiliary air supply tube **155** and fiber optic cable **160** can be coupled to enable convenient and/or safe handling and management of the fiber optic cable **160** and/or the auxiliary air supply tube **155**. For example, FIG. **14D** illustrates a handpiece assembly with a coupled fiber cable **160** and coupled air supply tube **155** in accordance some embodiments of the invention. As illustrated, some embodiments include a coupler **165** comprising an aperture **167** supporting the air supply tube **155**, and aperture **169** supporting the fiber optic cable **160**.

(54) FIG. **14E** illustrates one example embodiments of the handpiece assembly **10** in operation in contact mode in accordance some embodiments of the invention. As shown, in some embodiments, tip **227** can be coupled with a patient tissue surface **149** at an interface **144** where spray **146** can be directed. FIG. **14F** illustrates a beam **5** and spray **146** of the handpiece assembly in accordance some embodiments of the invention. In some embodiments, the spray **146** can intersect with the beam **5** (shown as region **8**). As discussed earlier, in some embodiments, the lower housing

extension **18** can curve inward so that the holder **80** positions the tubes **75, 77** pointing inward towards an axial center of the handpiece assembly, and allowing the spray mixer **84** to deliver air and water or other fluid across a beam **5**.

(55) Referring back to FIGS. **14A** and **14B**, in some embodiments of the invention, the handpiece assembly **10** can form part of a dental laser system or station **200, 250** that includes a display. For example, some non-limiting embodiments include of dental laser station **200** that includes display **201**, and another non-limiting example embodiment includes dental laser station **250** with display **251**. In some embodiments, the display **201, 251** can comprise a touchscreen display configured to enable a user to interact with a graphical user interface (hereafter “GUI”). For example, some non-limiting embodiments includes display **201** including a GUI **203**, and another non-limiting example embodiment includes display **251** including a GUI **253**. In some embodiments, user interactions with the GUI **203, 251** can include using single, multiple, or repeated physical contact with the display **201, 251** to initiate one or more functions of the dental laser system and a coupled handpiece (e.g., such as handpiece assembly **10**). For example, in some embodiments, the display **201, 251** can include a GUI **203, 253** comprising one or more displayed menus that can be navigated by user to control or monitor one or more functions of the handpiece assembly **10**.

(56) In some embodiments, the display (e.g., such as display **201** or display **251**) can form a communication of a computer system of the dental laser station (which can include a removable conventional tablet computer including a tablet display capable of displaying the GUI and/or a coupled remote and/or internet and/or cloud-based computer system). For example, FIG. **15** illustrates a computer system **300** useful for controlling and/or networking to a handpiece assembly **10** of a dental laser station in accordance with some embodiments of the invention. In some embodiments, the system **300** can control one or more components or systems of a dental laser station (e.g., such as the dental laser station **200** or dental laser station **250**) including any operation portion of a remote access function of the dental laser station **200, 250**. In some embodiments, the dental laser station **200** and/or dental laser station **250** can comprise the system **300**. In some embodiments of the invention, control systems, displays, and associated GUIs can be used to control and/or monitor some aspect, function, or operational characteristic of a dental laser station (e.g., such as the dental laser station **200** or dental laser station **250**) and/or a coupled component (e.g., such as handpiece assembly **10**), and/or communicate some function or operational characteristic, including one or more control and/or operating parameters of the handpiece assembly **10**.

(57) In some embodiments of the invention, the system **300** can comprise operating and processing modules for the handpiece assembly **10**. In some embodiments, the system **300** can include at least one computing device including one or more processors **320**. Some processors **320** can include processors residing in one or more conventional server platforms including within a cloud of computing resources. In some embodiments, the system **300** can include a network interface **350a** and/or an application interface **350b** coupled to at least one processor **320** capable of running at least one operating system **340**. Further, in some embodiments, the at least one processor **320** can be capable of running one or more of the software modules (e.g., such as enterprise applications **380**). In some embodiments, the system **300** can comprise at least one computer readable medium **360** coupled to at least one data storage device **370b**, and/or at least one data source **370a**, and/or at least one input/output device **370c**. In some embodiments, the computer readable medium **360** can be any data storage device that can store data, which can thereafter be read by a computer system (such as the system **300**). Examples of the computer readable medium **360** can include hard drives, network attached storage (NAS), read-only memory, random-access memory, FLASH based memory, CD-ROMs, CD-Rs, CD-RWs, DVDs, magnetic tapes, other optical and non-optical data storage devices, or any other physical or material medium which can be used to tangibly store the desired information or data or instructions and which can be accessed by a computer or processor (including processors **320**).

(58) Some embodiments include a remote access system and method embodied as computer readable code on the computer readable medium **360**. In some embodiments of the invention, the computer readable medium **360** can also be distributed over a conventional computer network via the network interface **350a** so that the computer readable code can be stored and executed in a distributed fashion. For example, in some embodiments, one or more components of the system **300** can be tethered to send and/or receive data through a local area network (“LAN”) **390a**. In some embodiments, one or more components of the system **300** can be tethered to send or receive data through an internet **390b** (e.g., a wireless internet). Further, in some embodiments, at least one software application **380** running on one or more processors **320** can be configured to be coupled for communication over a network **390a**, **390b**. In some embodiments, one or more components of the network **390a**, **390b** can include one or more resources for data storage, including any other form of computer readable media beyond the media **360** for storing information and including any form of computer readable media for communicating information from one electronic device to another electronic device.

(59) In some embodiments, the network **390a**, **390b** can include wide area networks (“WAN”), direct connections (e.g., through a universal serial bus port) or other forms of computer-readable media **360**, or any combination thereof. Further, in some embodiments, one or more components of the network **390a**, **390b** can include a number of client devices which can be one or more display and/or computers **400** including for example desktop computers **400d**, laptop computers **400a**, **400e**, digital assistants and/or personal digital assistants and/or digital tablets (shown as **400c**), cellular phones or mobile phones or smart phones (shown as **400b**), pagers, internet appliances, and other processor-based devices. In general, a client device can be any type of external or internal devices such as a conventional mouse, CD-ROM, DVD, keyboard (e.g., implemented as a hardware keyboard and/or a software-displayed keyboard, a passive or active display, or other input or output devices **370c**). In some embodiments, various other forms of computer-readable media **360** can transmit or carry instructions to one or more computers **400**, including a router, private or public network, or other transmission device or channel, both wired and wireless. In some embodiments, the software modules **380** can be configured to send and receive data from a database (e.g., from a computer readable medium **360** including data sources **370a** and data storage **370b** that can comprise a database), and data can be received by the software modules **380** from at least one other source.

(60) In some embodiments, at least one of the software modules **380** can be configured within the system **300** to output data to at least one user **310** via at least one digital display (e.g., to a computer comprising a digital display). In some embodiments, the display can include the display **201** or display **251** shown in FIGS. **14A** and **14B** respectively. In some embodiments, any of the computers **400** can comprise the display **201**, **251**. In some embodiments, the system **300** as described can enable one or more users **310** to receive, analyze, input, modify, create and send data to and from the system **300**, including to and from one or more enterprise applications **380** running on the system **300**. Some embodiments include at least one user **310** coupled to a computer **400** accessing one or more modules of the dentistry control system including at least one enterprise applications **380** via a stationary I/O device **370c** through a LAN **390a**. In some other embodiments, the system **300** can enable at least one user **310** (through computer **400**) accessing enterprise applications **380** via a stationary or mobile I/O device **370c** through an internet **390a**. In some embodiments, the software modules **380** can include a server-based software platform that can include dentistry control software modules suitable for hosting at least one user **310** account and/or at least one patient account or record.

(61) In some embodiments, the GUI can display one or more selectable menus, messages, and/or icons that can be used to select a dental handpiece and/or control at least one function of the handpiece such as handpiece assembly **10**. In some embodiments, basic settings can include pre-set settings, minimum and maximum settings. In some embodiments, the settings can include energy,

pulse rate, and power settings of the laser. Other settings can include air and water flow rate settings. Further, in some embodiments, the specific settings shown can vary based and are shown as non-limiting embodiments only. Other settings can be used without departing from the invention as described herein. For example, in some embodiments, displayed menus can include category buttons, any one of which can have one or more control system attributes. In some embodiments, these category buttons may be defined as, but not be limited to, dentin, enamel, anterior deciduous, hemostasis, perio, endo, incision/excision, de-sensitization and osseous.

(62) In some embodiments, the display **300** can comprise “soft” buttons that can be graphically rendered in a GUI, and/or can be hard buttons adjacent to the displays on a dental tool or associated control equipment, and/or a remote control or a WiFi linked system. In some embodiments, using one or more portions of the GUI, a user can enter, select, and/or modify one or more system or operational variables or attributes. For example, using at least one displayed feature, a user can use the GUI to control a plurality of system or operational variables or attributes. In some embodiments, these parameters can be modified interactively to adjust and optimize the operational characteristics of a dental laser prior to starting a dental procedure, during a dental procedure, and/or after a dental procedure has been performed. Some non-limiting example embodiments of GUI's configured to display one or more selectable menus, messages, and/or icons that can be used to select a dental handpiece and/or control at least one function of the handpiece assembly **10** are shown in FIGS. **16** and **17**.

(63) In reference to FIG. **16**, some embodiments include a select category **500** menu with system settings and parameters for various selectable procedures that can be performed using the handpiece assembly **10**. Some embodiments include system settings and parameters for soft tissue procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **505**). Some further embodiments include system settings and parameters for restorative procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **510**). Other embodiments include system settings and parameters for endodontic procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **515**). Some further embodiments include system settings and parameters for periodontic procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **525**). Some embodiments of the invention include system settings and parameters for implant procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **530**). Some further embodiments include system settings and parameters for expanded procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **535**). Some further embodiments include system settings and parameters for repair periodontic procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **530**). Further embodiments include system settings and parameters for repair implant procedures, options, and steps (shown as selectable icon **530**).

(64) In reference to FIG. **17**, some embodiments include a GUI **550** configured for showing operational and control parameters of the handpiece assembly **10**. For example, some embodiments include a laser parameter display **555a** for displaying and/or controlling laser parameters of the handpiece assembly **10**. Other embodiments include a spray parameter display **555b** for displaying and/or controlling spray parameters of the handpiece assembly **10**. Some embodiments include a power meter **555** with selectable power level **557**, and a laser mode **559** display and/or selector. In some embodiments, a selectable slider for modifying and/or setting at least one parameter of the procedure can be displayed. Some further embodiments include a pulse display **562** with selectable pulse icon **565**. In some embodiments, the GUI **550** can include an air delivery display **568** with air setting **570** and/or air mode **572**. Further, some embodiments include a water delivery display **574** with water setting **576**, and water mode icon **578**. Some embodiments also include an auxiliary icon **590** for selecting or indicating auxiliary components and/or sources providing air and/or water. In some embodiments, a handpiece exchange icon **580** and/or tip exchange icon **585** can be used to install and/or swap a handpiece and/or tip of the handpiece assembly **10**.

(65) In reference to FIG. **17A**, illustrating another example GUI display configured for showing operational and control parameters of the handpiece assembly **10**, some embodiments include a

GUI **600** comprising selectable favorite settings. In some embodiments, the GUI **600** can include a current setting display bar **610** displaying or monitoring one or more operating parameters or settings of the handpiece assembly **10** and/or a coupled laser system (e.g., such as dental laser station **200** and/or dental laser station **250**). In some embodiments, a user can select one or more settings, operational parameters and/or monitored parameters of the handpiece assembly **10** and/or a coupled laser system (e.g., such as dental laser station **200** and/or dental laser station **250** by accessing one or more favorite icons **620**.

(66) With the above embodiments in mind, it should be understood that the invention can employ various computer-implemented operations involving dentistry control data stored in computer systems. Moreover, the above-described databases and models throughout the dentistry control can store analytical models and other data on computer-readable storage media within the system **300** and on computer-readable storage media coupled to the system **300**. In addition, the above-described applications of the dentistry control system can be stored on computer-readable storage media within the system **300** and on computer-readable storage media coupled to the system **300**. These operations are those requiring physical manipulation of physical quantities. Usually, though not necessarily, these quantities take the form of electrical, electromagnetic, or magnetic signals, optical or magneto-optical form capable of being stored, transferred, combined, compared and otherwise manipulated.

(67) Any of the operations described herein that form part of the invention are useful machine operations. The invention also relates to a device or an apparatus for performing these operations. The apparatus can be specially constructed for the required purpose, such as a special purpose computer. When defined as a special purpose computer, the computer can also perform other processing, program execution or routines that are not part of the special purpose, while still being capable of operating for the special purpose. Alternatively, the operations can be processed by a general purpose computer selectively activated or configured by one or more computer programs stored in the computer memory, cache, or obtained over a network. When data is obtained over a network the data can be processed by other computers on the network, e.g. a cloud of computing resources.

(68) The embodiments of the present invention can also be defined as a machine that transforms data from one state to another state. The data can represent an article, that can be represented as an electronic signal and electronically manipulate data. The transformed data can, in some cases, be visually depicted on a display, representing the physical object that results from the transformation of data. The transformed data can be saved to storage generally or in particular formats that enable the construction or depiction of a physical and tangible object. In some embodiments, the manipulation can be performed by a processor. In such an example, the processor thus transforms the data from one thing to another. Still further, the methods can be processed by one or more machines or processors that can be connected over a network. Each machine can transform data from one state or thing to another, and can also process data, save data to storage, transmit data over a network, display the result, or communicate the result to another machine. Computer-readable storage media, as used herein, refers to physical or tangible storage (as opposed to signals) and includes without limitation volatile and non-volatile, removable and non-removable storage media implemented in any method or technology for the tangible storage of information such as computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data.

(69) Although method operations can be described in a specific order, it should be understood that other housekeeping operations can be performed in between operations, or operations can be adjusted so that they occur at slightly different times, or can be distributed in a system which allows the occurrence of the processing operations at various intervals associated with the processing, as long as the processing of the overlay operations are performed in the desired way.

(70) It will be appreciated by those skilled in the art that while the invention has been described above in connection with particular embodiments and examples, the invention is not necessarily so

limited, and that numerous other embodiments, examples, uses, modifications and departures from the embodiments, examples and uses are intended to be encompassed therein. Various features and advantages of the invention are set forth in the following claims.

Claims

1. A system comprising; a laser delivery system configured to deliver electromagnetic energy via a fiber optic cable; and a handpiece assembly coupled to the fiber optic cable and configured to receive the electromagnetic energy from the laser delivery system, the handpiece assembly further configured to receive an air supply and at least one fluid, and to selectively, simultaneously deliver the electromagnetic energy, air supply and the at least one fluid to a target surface, the handpiece assembly comprising components including: a spray mixer positioned at a distal end of the handpiece assembly, the spray mixer coupled to fluid lines of the plurality of fluid lines; and an air coupler comprising an air input port and an air delivery channel, the air coupler coupled to a housing extension of the handpiece assembly, the air coupler configured to couple on-demand air to the handpiece assembly via the air input port and air delivery channel, the air delivery channel configured to deliver the air supply from the air input port to the target surface via a tip of an exchangeable disposable, single use applicator that is coupled to a distal end of the handpiece assembly and cannot be removed from the distal end without breaking the applicator, thereby rendering the applicator incapable of reuse; a graphical user interface (GUI) display communicatively linked to the laser delivery system, the GUI display configured to display an operating status and a selectable parameter of the handpiece assembly, the selectable parameter corresponding to the operation status and output of at least one component of the handpiece assembly; and a processor and a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium in data communication with the processor, the non-transitory computer-readable storage medium including a process executable by the processor that enables interaction and control of the handpiece assembly and laser delivery system.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the selectable parameters of the handpiece assembly include at least one of a laser power, and a laser pulse width.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the selectable parameters of the handpiece assembly comprise at least one selectable favorite selected from a GUI comprising a favorites selection window or icon.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the selectable parameters of the handpiece assembly comprise at least one selectable category selected from a GUI comprising a category selection window.
5. The system of claim 1, wherein the GUI comprises a spray parameter display configured for displaying and/or controlling spray parameters of the handpiece assembly.
6. The system of claim 1, wherein the GUI includes at least one of a power meter with selectable power level, and a laser mode display and/or selector, a selectable slider configured for modifying and/or setting at least one parameter of a procedure, and a pulse display with selectable pulse icon.
7. The system of claim 1, wherein the GUI includes an air delivery display with air setting and/or air mode.
8. The system of claim 1, wherein the GUI includes a water delivery display with water setting, and water mode icon.
9. The system of claim 1, wherein the GUI includes an auxiliary icon configured for selecting or indicating auxiliary components and/or sources providing air and/or water.
10. The system of claim 1, wherein the GUI includes a handpiece exchange icon and/or tip exchange icon configurable to install and/or swap a handpiece and/or tip of the handpiece assembly.
11. The system of claim 1, wherein the disposable applicator comprises at least one structure configured and arranged to weaken or reduce the mechanical strength or integrity of at least one coupler extending from a main body of the disposable applicator, the at least one coupler

configured and arranged to at least partially secure the disposable tip to the distal end of the handpiece assembly.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein the coupler comprises a clip.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the notch is positioned at an edge of the main body of the disposable applicator, and extends at least partially into the at least one coupler, wherein the at least one coupler is configured by the notch to break from the main body when a user removes the disposable applicator from the handpiece assembly.

14. The system of claim 1, wherein the spray mixer is positioned in a lower housing extension that curves inward so that an output of the spray mixer is guided towards an axial center of the handpiece assembly.

15. The system of claim 1, wherein the disposable applicator comprises a valve, the valve configured to couple to a connector at the distal end of the handpiece assembly.

16. The system of claim 15, wherein the valve comprises a duckbill valve.

17. An assembly comprising: a handpiece assembly configured to receive electromagnetic energy, an air supply and at least one fluid, and to selectively, simultaneously deliver the electromagnetic energy, the air supply and the at least one fluid to a target surface, the handpiece assembly comprising: a handpiece housing and a plurality of fluid lines extending through the hand piece housing, the plurality of fluid lines configured to transfer the at least one fluid from a proximal end of the handpiece assembly to a distal end of the handpiece assembly; a spray mixer positioned at the distal end, the spray mixer coupled to fluid lines of the plurality of fluid lines; and an air coupler comprising an air input port and an air delivery channel, the air coupler coupled to a housing extension of the handpiece housing, the air coupler configured to couple on-demand air to the handpiece assembly via the air input port and air delivery channel, the air delivery channel configured to deliver the air supply from the air input port to a tip of disposable, single use applicator that is coupled to a distal end of the handpiece housing, wherein the applicator is configured to break when uncoupled from the distal end thereby preventing applicator reuse.

18. The assembly of claim 17, further comprising a disposable applicator, the disposable applicator comprising at least one structure configured and arranged to weaken or have reduced mechanical strength or integrity of at least one coupler extending from a main body of the disposable applicator, the at least one coupler configured and arranged to at least partially secure the disposable tip to the distal end of the handpiece assembly.

19. The assembly of claim 18, wherein the at least one structure comprises a notch.

20. The assembly of claim 19, wherein the notch is positioned at an edge of the main body and extends at least partially into the at least one coupler, wherein the at least one coupler is configured by the notch to break from the main body when a user removes the disposable applicator from the handpiece assembly.
